

- This means that, contra Nestorius, there *is* commerce between divinity and humanity in Christ. You *can* say, for instance, that ‘God died on the cross’ or even ‘God suffered,’ if by that you mean that God suffered *through* the humanity that God assumed. In other words, it wasn’t ‘just the humanity’ that suffered, it was ‘God-enfleshed’ who suffered. There is a real ‘communication of properties’ that is going on between the divinity and humanity, because there is only one person who is the subject of the experiences of both. Hence, Cyril will say in his treatise on the unity of Christ, ‘the Word of God suffers impassibly’ – that is, the subject of the experience – the Word – is both God (‘impassibly’) and human (‘suffers’).
- This amounts to neither a ‘crass mixture’ theology nor a ‘two sons’ Christology for the following reasons.
 - To be a ‘crass mixture’ would mean a violation of the very principle that Cyril is trying to defend: genuine *fellowship* between God and humanity. Because of the incarnation, God now ‘knows what it’s like’ to be human *whilst still being God*.
 - There are not ‘two sons’ because there is only one ‘hypostasis’ – there is only one ‘reality’ as a result of the union. There is only one ‘enfleshed Son’ – not two separate individuated realities that operate together, simultaneously.
- At Chalcedon, this would get cashed out in somewhat more Nestorian-friendly terms, with reference specifically to ‘two natures’ (dyophysitism) in one person, as perhaps a concession to the other side (a concession which was apparently too much for some extreme Cyrillians, hence the post-Chalcedonian schism leading to the Monophysite churches – e.g., the Syrian Orthodox). But even at Chalcedon, Cyril’s theology is front and centre. There is only one ‘reality’ that is Jesus Christ, and hence Jesus should be worshipped and received as such.
- In terms of biblical exegesis, Cyril’s Christology likewise created more space for reading the text ‘literally’ without violating the Creator-creature distinction. To be a Nestorian, one must always ask the question: which part of Jesus is undertaking this particular act? For Cyril, one need only say, ‘the subject of *any* action Jesus undertakes is God-enfleshed.’ Jesus, in other words, is not wandering through the world ‘activating’ this or that part of himself at various points. Rather, the one subject who is Jesus does things in virtue of his humanity and in virtue of divinity, with neither being excluded from any particular act. This may sound strange, but recall that for Cyril, it is absolutely essential for his understanding of salvation. If the divinity simply ‘sat on the side’ whilst Jesus did human things, then there would be no scope for the *transformation* of the humanity in those moments. Likewise, if the humanity simply lay dormant whilst Jesus performed miracles, there would be no taking up of humanity into the presence of God (i.e., the telos of all human beings). This is why, for instance, the cross can be both tragedy and victory: it is tragedy because it represents in fullness the brutality of human injustice and the horror of human sin, *and* it is victory because it is the overcoming of these things as God in the flesh traverses through them for our salvation. As McGuckin puts it, Cyril succeeded in extending the Nicene settlement by ‘presenting an unquestionable icon of Christ who was fully divine in and through his humanity, not in spite of it.’ (p.223).

E. POSTSCRIPT: MODERN KENOSIS THEORY